

20. The original name of Banda Bahadur was –

- (a) Mahesh Das
- (b) Lachhman Dev
- (c) Dwarka Das
- (d) Harnam Das

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (b)

The real name of Banda Bahadur was Lachman Dev. This name was given to him by Sikh Guru Gobind Singh.

Maratha State and Confederacy

*Shivaji was born at the fort of **Shivneri** in **1627 or 1630 A.D.** He adopted the title of Chhatrapati after his coronation in **1674 A.D.** He made **Raigarh** his capital. ***Pandit Vishweshwar** alias '**Gagabhatta**', a great scholar of that era, declared Shivaji a Kshatriya at his coronation. **Shivaji** died in **1680 A.D.** at the age of 53 or 50 years.

*The reason for the rise of Maratha power was its residents.

*The unity of the people on the grounds of caste, language, religion, literature and residence flourished the feeling of nationalism among them. The geographical conditions of Maharashtra were helpful in flourishing the Maratha power.

*The high leadership quality of Shivaji and other Maratha leaders contributed to the rise of Maratha power.

*In **1659 A.D.**, the Sultan of Bijapur sent his experienced and trusted commander **Afzal Khan** for suppression of Shivaji, but the diplomat and clever Shivaji killed him.

***Treaty of Purandar** was signed between Shivaji and **Jai Singh** in **1665 A.D.** Shivaji was imprisoned in Jaipur Bhawan at Agra when he escaped from the custody of Mughals. Aurangzeb imprisoned Shivaji in **1666 A.D.** at Agra.

*'**Ashtapradhan**' was the Council of Eight Ministers constituted by Shivaji for Maratha administration.

The eight ministers were –

- (i) **Peshwa** - Prime Minister of the King .
- (ii) **Amatya** - Finance and Revenue Minister .
- (iii) **Waqianavis/Mantri** - Interior Minister, managing internal affairs, especially intelligence and espionage .
- (iv) **Sachiv/Surnavis** - Responsible for all correspondence.
- (v) **Sumant/Dabir** - Foreign Minister .
- (vi) **Senapati/Sar-i-Naubat** - Maintenance of appointments, organization and food supply of military.
- (vii) **Pandit Rao** - Appointed for religious aid.
- (viii) **Nyayadhish** - Chief Justice.

***Rajaram** led the Marathas as a representative of **Shahu** from **1689 A.D.** to **1700 A.D.** After the death of Rajaram, his widow **Tarabai** continued the struggle with the Mughals placing his four year old son **Shivaji-II** on the throne. At the time of Aurangzeb's death, the Maratha leadership was in the hands of Tarabai.

*After **Sambhaji**, the power of Maratha kingdom came in the hands of **Balaji Vishwanath** who made the administration easy and convenient. *Maratha **Chhatrapati Shahu** appointed Balaji to the post of Peshwa. November 1713 was an important day not only for Balaji but also for the whole Marathas as the power was transferred from Chhatrapati to the Peshwa.

***Balaji Vishwanath** reigned from **1713 A.D.** to **1720 A.D.**

*Shahu appointed the elder son of Balaji Vishwanath, **Bajirao - I** as Peshwa whose tenure was from **1720 A.D.** to **1740 A.D.**

***Balaji Bajirao** ruled from **1740 A.D.** to **1761 A.D.** after the death of Bajirao. **Madhavrao's** tenure was from **1761 A.D.** to **1772 A.D.**

*After the death of Madhavrao in **1772 A.D.**, his brother **Narayanrao** became a victim of the conspiracy of his uncle **Raghunathrao**, who himself wanted to become Peshwa.

*By the time of **Balaji Bajirao**, the Post of **Peshwa** became hereditary. Previously the power was in the hands of the **Chhatrapati**, but now the centre of power shifted into the hands of **Peshwas**. By the **treaty of Sangola in 1750 A.D.**, the Maratha King became a "do nothing king" and just the Mayor of a palace and Peshwa emerged as the real and effective head of Maratha confederacy.

***Saranzami system** was related to land revenue in Maratha period. The land given under Saranzami system was provided for the livelihood of Maratha Jagirdar during the Maratha period.

*In January, **1757 A.D.**, **Ahmad Shah Abdali** entered Delhi and looted up to Agra and Mathura. Before returning to his motherland, he appointed **Alamgir II** as Emperor, **Imadulmulk** as prime minister and Rohilla leader **Najib-Ud-Daulah** as his chief agent and Mir Bakshi of the Empire.

***The third battle of Panipat** was fought between Maratha Sadashivrao Bhau and Afghan invader Ahmad Shah Abdali on **14th January 1761**. Marathas were badly defeated by Afghans in this battle. According to Kashiraj Pandit, a historian who was eyewitness of this battle 'Third battle of Panipat proved catastrophic for Marathas.' "Two pearls have been dissolved, 22 gold coins have been lost and of the silver and copper the total cannot be cast up" that was the message which was sent to Balaji Bajirao in encrypted form by a merchant after this agonising defeat of Marathas. The immediate reason for the battle of Panipat was the Ahmad Shah Abdali's desire to avenge Marathas as they expelled his Viceroy **Timur Shah** from Lahore. ***Ahilyabai** was a Maratha ruler from Holkar dynasty. Holkars belong to Indore.

1. Which is/are correct reasons of Maratha's Rise?

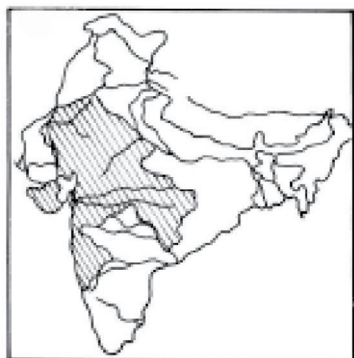
- (a) Religious Consciousness
- (b) Geographical Security
- (c) Political awakening
- (d) High quality of leadership
- (e) all of the above

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (e)

All factors are correct for the rise of Marathas. Maratha's rise was neither specific nor the result of unstable circumstances generated in a specific period. The reason for Maratha rise was its residents, whose nationalism was on the ground of unity, caste, language, religion, literature and habitat. The geographical conditions of Maharashtra were helpful in flourishing the Maratha power. The high leadership quality of Shivaji and other Maratha leaders contributed to the rise of Maratha power.

2. Consider the map given below-



The shaded area in the map shows the Kingdom of the—

- (a) Satavahanas
- (b) Chalukyas of Vatapi
- (c) Rashtrakutas
- (d) Marathas

I.A.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

The above-shaded areas in the map show the extent of territories, ruled by Marathas.

3. Shivaji defeated the Mughals in the battle of-

- (a) Purandar
- (b) Raigarh
- (c) Salher
- (d) Shivner

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (c)

Shivaji defeated the Mughals in Salher battle in 1672 A.D. He was born in 1627 or 1630 A.D., in Shivneri Fort. He assumed the title of "Chhatrapati" after his coronation in 1674 AD.

4. When was Shivaji born and when did he assume the title of Chhatrapati?

- (a) 1626, 1675
- (b) 1625, 1671
- (c) 1627, 1661
- (d) 1627, 1674

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

5. Who was the commander sent by Sultan of Bijapur for repression of Shivaji in 1659?

- (a) Inayat Khan
- (b) Afzal Khan
- (c) Shaista Khan
- (d) Sayyid Banda

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (b)

In 1659 A.D., Bijapur Sultan sent his experienced and trusted commander Afzal Khan for suppression of Shivaji, but the diplomat and clever Shivaji killed him.

6. In which city was Shivaji in captivity when he escaped from the custody of the Mughals?

- (a) Gwalior
- (b) Agra
- (c) Delhi
- (d) Kanpur

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

Shivaji was in captivity in Jaipur Bhawan at Agra when he escaped from the custody of the Mughals. Aurangzeb imprisoned Shivaji at Agra in 1666 A.D. So, option (b) will be the correct answer.

7. Where was the capital of Shivaji?

- (a) Raigarh
- (b) Satara
- (c) Purandar
- (d) Tanjore

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (a)

Shivaji was coronated in 1674 A.D. with the title of "Chhatrapati" and made Raigarh his capital. Vishveshwar (Gaga Bhatt), the famous contemporary scholar of Benares (Banaras), coronated and declared him Kshatriya.

8. Where was the capital of Shivaji?

- (a) Raigarh
- (b) Sindhudurg
- (c) Poona
- (d) Kolhapur

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

9. Where was Shivaji formally crowned as Chhatrapati?

- (a) Pune
- (b) Kolhapur
- (c) Raigarh
- (d) Ahmednagar

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (c)

Shivaji Bhonsle also known as Chhatrapati Shivaji, was crowned as the Chhatrapati in 1674 A.D. at Raigarh. The coronation ceremony was performed by Vishweshwar also called Gaga Bhatta of Varanasi.

10. What was the name of Shivaji's Guru?

- (a) Ramdas (b) Tukaram
(c) Vaman Pandit (d) Gaga Bhatt

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

Samarth Ramdas was the guru of Shivaji. He is remembered for his Advaita Vedantic text 'Daasbodh.' He also wrote the poem in praise of King Shivaji by the name of 'Shivastuti.'

11. Arrange the following events related to Chhatrapati Shivaji in chronological order and select the correct answer from the code given below.

- I. The victory on the Fort of Chakan**
II. The episode of Afzal Khan
III. Start of clash with the Mughals
IV. Attack and sack of Surat.

Code:

- (a) I, III, II, IV (b) I, II, III, IV
(c) II, IV, III, I (d) II, III, I, IV

U.P.R.O./ A.R.O. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (a)

Following is the sequence of events:
The episode of Afzal Khan-1659 A.D.
Start of clash with Mughals -1657 A.D.
Victory on the Fort of Chakan - 1648 A.D.
Attack and sack of Surat - 1664 A.D.

12. Ashtapradhan was a Council of Ministers :

- (a) In the Gupta administration
(b) In the Chola administration
(c) In the Vijayanagara administration
(d) In the Maratha administration

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

I.A.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

'Ashtapradhan' was a council of eight ministers constituted by Shivaji in Maratha administration.
The eight ministers were 1. Peshwa, 2. Pandit Rao, 3. Sumant, 4. Amatya, 5. Mantri, 6. Sachiv, 7. Senapati, 8. Nyayadhish.
(i) Peshwa- Prime Minister of King
(ii) Amatya or Mazumdar- Finance and Revenue Minister
(iii) Waqianavis/Mantri- Interior minister, managing internal affairs, especially intelligence and espionage.
(iv) Sachiv/Surnavis-Responsible for all correspondence.
(v) Sumant/Dabir- Foreign Minister
(vi) Senapati/Sar-i-Naubat - Maintenance of appointments, organization and food supply of military.
(vii) Pandit Rao- High Priest
(viii) Nyayadhish- Chief Justice

13. Match the following in context of Asht Pradhan system of Maratha rulers :

Official	Department
A. Sachiva	1. Prime Minister
B. Peshwa	2. In charge of Correspondence
C. Samant	3. Finance Minister
D. Amatya	4. Foreign Minister

Choose the correct option :

- (a) A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
(b) A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4
(c) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2
(d) More than one of the above

70th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

14. 'Ashta Pradhan' was a Council of Ministers

- (a) In the Gupta administration
(b) In the Chola administration
(c) In the Maratha administration
(d) In the Vijayanagara administration

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

15. Who established Ashta Pradhan?

- (a) Chandragupta
(b) Ashoka
(c) Harshavardhana
(d) Shivaji
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

16. 'Ashta Pradhan' was helping in Administration of which ruler?

- (a) Babur (b) Akbar
(c) Aurangzeb (d) Shivaji
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

17. The following were the Officers in the 'Ashtapradhan' of Shivaji:

- 1. Mazumdar**
2. Dabir
3. Waknis
4. Surnis

Select the correct answer :

- (a) 1, 2, 3
(c) 1, 2, 4
(e) 1,2,3,4

- (b) 2, 3, 4
(d) 1, 3, 4

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (e)

See the explanation of above question.

18. At the time of Shivaji, the post of 'Sarnobat' was related to –

- (a) Financial administration
(b) Judicial administration
(c) Local administration
(d) Military administration

U.P.P.S.C. (R.I.) 2014

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

19. The member of Shivaji's Ashtapradhan who looked after foreign affairs was :

- (a) Peshwa (b) Sachiv
(c) Pandit Rao (d) Sumant

I.A.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

20. During the reign of Shivaji, the foreign minister was known as –

- (a) Sumant (b) Amatya
(c) Sar-i-Naubat (d) Sachiv

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

21. "Ashtapradhan"-a Council of Ministers helped in discharge of State affairs to :

- (a) Harshavardhana (b) Samudra Gupta
(c) Shivaji (d) Yashovarman

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

22. Assertion (A) : In matters of State Shivaji was advised by a Council of Ministers.

Reason (R) : Each minister held independent charge of his department.

Code:

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).

- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

The "Ashtapradhan" was a council of eight ministers who administered the Maratha empire during Shivaji reign. They were not working as a cabinet, each minister was the head of his department. It was up to Shivaji whether he accepted or rejected the given advice. Ashtapradhan acted as the secretary of Shivaji. To follow the orders of Shivaji and look after the state widely were the main functions of the Ministers. So, assertion (A) is correct but reason (R) is incorrect.

23. Below are two statements, one of which is an Assertion (A) and the other is a Reason (R):

Assertion (A) : Shivaji had to face opposition from big Deshmukhs.

Reason (R) : These Deshmukhs were not in support of the independent Maratha state and wanted to remain as feudal lords of Bijapur.

Choose the correct answer from the options given below :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) (A) is false, but (R) is true.
(c) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(d) (A) is true, but (R) is false.

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (a)

Shivaji had to face opposition from powerful landlords (Deshmukhs) because the landlords wanted to maintain their power and influence. Hence, statement (A) is true. The Deshmukhs were not in favour of an independent Maratha state and wanted to remain subordinates of Bijapur, as remaining under Bijapur allowed them autonomy and opportunities to maintain their special privileges. This is why they opposed Shivaji. Thus, statement (R) is also true, and (R) correctly explains (A).

24. Which of the following coins was NOT a silver coin in the Kingdom of Chhatrapati Shivaji?

- (a) Rupaya (b) Lari
(c) Taka (d) Ruka

U.P.R.O./ A.R.O. (Mains) 2016

Ans (d)

Lari, Rupaya & Taka were silver coins during the reign of Chhatrapati Shivaji, while Ruka was a coin in Kakatiya dynasty.

25. Who among the following streamlined the Maratha administration after Shambhaji?

- (a) Rajaram (b) Balaji Viswanath
(c) Ganga Bai (d) Nanaji Deshmukh

I.A.S. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

After Sambhaji, the power of the Maratha Kingdom came into the hands of Balaji Vishwanath who made the administration easy and convenient. November 1713 A.D. was important not only for Balaji but also for whole Marathas as the power was transferred from Chhatrapati to the Peshwas. His main achievement was a temporary agreement between the Mughals and the Marathas by which the authority and region were properly described.

26. Arrange the following in the chronological order of their rule :

- (1) Bajirao
- (2) Balaji Bajirao
- (3) Balaji Vishwanath
- (4) Madhavrao

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

Code :

- (a) 4, 3, 1, 2 (b) 1, 2, 3, 4
(c) 3, 1, 2, 4 (d) 2, 1, 4, 3

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

Ans. (c)

Balaji Vishwanath reigned from 1713 A.D. to 1720 A.D.. Shahu appointed the elder son of Balaji Vishwanath Bajirao-I as Peshwa whose tenure was from 1720 to 1740 A.D.. Balaji Bajirao reigned from 1740 to 1761 A.D. after the death of Bajirao. Madhavrao's tenure was from 1761 to 1772 A.D..

27. Consider the reign of following Peshwas and arrange them in chronological order –

- I. Balaji Vishwanath
- II. Bajirao I
- III. Narayan Rao
- IV. Madhav Rao I

Select the correct answer using the code given, below–
Code -

- (a) I, II, IV, III (b) II, I, IV, III
(c) I, II, III, IV (d) I, III, II, IV

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

Balaji Vishwanath (1713-1720)
Bajirao I (1720-1740)
Madhav Rao I (1761-1772)
Narayan Rao (1772-1773)
Hence option (a) is correct answer.

28. Consider the following Peshwas and arrange them in chronological order :

1. Raghunath Rao (Raghoba)
2. Balaji Bajirao
3. Narayan Rao

4. Balaji Vishwanath

Choose the correct answer from the options given below:

- (a) 4, 2, 3, 1 (b) 3, 4, 1, 2
(c) 1, 2, 3, 4 (d) 1, 3, 2, 4

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (a)

Peshwa	Tenure
Balaji Vishwanath	1713-20 CE
Balaji Bajirao	1740-61 CE
Narayan Rao	1772-73 CE
Raghunath Rao (Raghoba)	1773-74 CE

Thus, the correct chronological order will be:
Balaji Vishwanath → Balaji Bajirao → Narayan Rao → Raghunath Rao (Raghoba).

29. Arrange the following in the correct chronological order:

1. Chhatrapati Shahuji
2. Rajaram
3. Sambhaji
4. Shivaji- II

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Code :

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| | A | B | C | D |
| (a) | 3 | 2 | 1 | 4 |
| (b) | 3 | 2 | 4 | 1 |
| (c) | 2 | 3 | 1 | 4 |
| (d) | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (b)

The correct chronological order is as follows-
Sambhaji – (1680-1689 A.D.) (Elder son of Shivaji)
Rajaram – (1689-1700 A.D.) (Second son of Shivaji)
Shivaji - II – (1700-1708 A.D.) (Son of Raja Ram)
Chhatrapati Shahuji – (1708-1749 A.D.) (Son of Sambhaji)

30. Assertion (A) : By 1750 the Maratha kingdom had become a Confederacy presided over by the Peshwa.

Reason (R) : The successors of Shahu depended on the will of the Peshwa.

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

Ans. (a)

Shahu appointed Balaji Bajirao as Peshwa after the death of Bajirao in 1740 A.D.. Now, the designation of Peshwa became patrimonial. By the Sangola agreement of 1750 A.D., the Maratha king became a "do nothing king" and the Mayor of the Palace, and the Peshwa emerged as the real and effective head of Maratha Confederacy.

31. The Maratha King became a non-entity and the Peshwa, the virtual ruler from the time of –

- (a) Balaji Vishwanath
- (b) Bajirao I
- (c) Balaji Bajirao
- (d) Madhavrao I

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

32. Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Marathas emerged as the strongest native power in India after the decline of Mughal Empire.

Reason (R): Marathas were the first rulers who had a clear concept of United Indian Nation.

Choose the correct answer from the code given below.

Code:

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- (c) (A) is true but (R) is false
- (d) (A) is false but (R) is true

U.P.R.O./ A.R.O. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (c)

After the decline of Mughals, Marathas were the most capable native power who could have taken the place of Mughals. Rise of Maratha power was based on people of Maharashtra and they were united as a nation on the basis of Maratha identity. However Maratha's failed to develop a concept of unified India which is a major criticism against them. Hence statement (A) is correct but (R) is false.

33. At the time of Aurangzeb's death, the Maratha leadership was in the hands of ?

- (a) Sambhaji
- (b) Rajaram
- (c) Jijabai
- (d) Tarabai

U.P. R.O./A.R.O (Mains) 2013

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (d)

Rajaram led Marathas as a representative of Shahu from 1689 to 1700 A.D.. After the death of Rajaram, his widow Tarabai struggled with the Mughals on behalf of her son Shivaji-II. At the time of Aurangzeb's death, the Maratha leadership was in the hands of Tarabai.

34. Who among the following Maratha women led struggles against the Mughal Empire from 1700 A.D. onwards?

- (a) Ahilya Bai
- (b) Mukta Bai
- (c) Tara Bai
- (d) Rukmini Bai

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

After the death of Rajaram, his minor son Shivaji-II became king and widow Tarabai became his regent. Tarabai was a brave lady. She led the struggle against the Mughals and took the forts of Singhgarh, Raigarh and Satara from Mughals.

35. Saranzami system was related to –

- (a) Land revenue system of Maratha
- (b) Taluqdari system
- (c) Qutb Shahi administration
- (d) None of the above

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

Saranzami system was related to land revenue in the Maratha period. The land given under Saranzami system was provided for the livelihood of Maratha Jagirdars during the Maratha period.

36. The Maratha claim of revenue for protection is known by what name?

- (a) Sardesh Mukhi
- (b) Chauth
- (c) Abwab
- (d) Jamadani

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (b)

Chauth was the revenue for protection claimed by Marathas. It was collected from the provinces which were known as Mughalai.

37. A historian witness to the third battle of Panipat. Who was he?

- (a) Khafi Khan
- (b) Kashiraj Pandit
- (c) Dattaji Pingle
- (d) Harcharan Das

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (b)

The third battle of Panipat was fought between Maratha Sadashivrao Bhau and Afghan invader Ahmad Shah Abdali on 14th January, 1761. Marathas were badly defeated by Afghans in this battle. According to Kashiraj Pandit, a historian who was an eyewitness of this battle "The Third Battle of Panipat became catastrophic for Marathas".